Mel Wong

STAFF PRODUCT DESIGNER

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ABOUT

Staff Product Designer with 10 years designing systems that help people make confident decisions at scale. My career spans fintech, developer tools, global consumer platforms, and high-velocity growth environments — each building a different dimension of how I approach complex product problems. I bring the rigor of large-scale experimentation to foundational product experiences, bridging business outcomes with long-term experience quality.

CORE SKILLS

Leadership: 0-to-1 Strategy · Interim Product Management · XFN Stakeholder Alignment · Staff-level Mentorship & Org Influence

Systems: Systems Thinking (2B+ user scale) · Design Systems Governance · Unified Platform Architecture · Complex IA

Technical: Data-Informed Experimentation · AI-Augmented Prototyping (Cursor, xCode, Claude, Figma Make) · Developer Experience · Multi-platform Execution

EDUCATION

University of California, Davis
B.A English Literature, Criticism & Theory

PAST WORK

itsmelwong.com
pw: Hellotheremyfriend

EXPERIENCE

Instagram

Senior Product Design / San Francisco Bay Area / Jul 2022 — Present

- **Interim Product Leadership:** Managed product strategy, engineering priorities, and team vision in absence of PM/EM; consistent "Greatly Exceeds" performance rating.
- **Platform Architecture:** Re-architected legacy systems on logged-out web, improving product ecosystem coherence and driving DAU growth through structural changes.
- **Multi-team Execution:** Led 11 engineers across 40+ launches; shaped cross-functional prioritization and design direction at the organizational level, exceeding growth targets by X%.
- **Retention Systems:** Redesigned onboarding and notification architecture end-to-end, improving early-lifecycle user confidence and long-term platform engagement through structural UX improvements.
- **Global Strategies:** Directed 9+ global experiences to reduce registration friction, translating competitive strategy into scalable, multi-market systems.

Spotify

Senior Product Design / New York, NY / Aug 2019 — Jul 2022

- **Platform Unification:** Re-architected fragmented account management into a unified self-serve system — a systems design problem as much as UX — increasing net subscribers by 530k+ and join rates by 3.41%
- **0-to-1 Market Launch:** Led end-to-end product design for South Korea market entry; localized experiences for regional behaviors while preserving platform consistency at scale.
- **Experimentation Rigor:** Built global upgrade funnel architecture through iterative, data-driven testing across platforms.

Betterment

Product Design / New York, NY / Aug 2018 — Aug 2019

- **Trust & Decision Systems:** Simplified complex investment flows and plan sponsor dashboards for high-stakes financial decisions requiring clarity and confidence.
- **B2B Blueprinting:** Led design for B2B product suite, including consumer dashboards and internal ops tooling across multiple user types
- **Constraint-drive Design:** Partnered with Legal and Compliance to bridge sophisticated wealth management with human-centered UI.

MongoDB

Product Design / New York, NY / Aug 2015 — Aug 2018

- **Team Management:** Led the NYC brand design team and led research and design for Education and Documentation.
- **Developer Experience & Systems:** Launched the MongoDB University design system and re-architected Docs to improve discoverability decreasing support tickets by 40%.
- **Strategic Bridge:** Aligned Design and Eng to scale developer onboarding tools to increase product adoption.